

He also added that non-free game programs (like other non-free programs) are unethical because they deny freedom to their users. (Game art is a different issue, because it isn't software.) If you want freedom, one requisite for it is not having non-free programs on your computer. That much is clear. However, if you're going to use these games, you're better off using them on GNU/Linux rather than on Microsoft Windows.

Stallman thinks that Steam's move might do both harm and good. It could encourage GNU/Linux users to install these games, and it might encourage users of the games to replace Windows with GNU/Linux. While Stallman thinks that the direct positive effect will be larger than the direct harm, it will teach bad things to little outsourcers.

The Linux guru also added that if hardline open sourcers want to promote freedom, they should not talk about the availability of these games on GNU/Linux as supporting their cause.

Torvalds releases Linux 3.5 Kernel

For all those Linux lovers, the wait is finally over! The Linux 3.5 Kernel has been released by Linus Torvalds. The fully furnished kernel with better support for hybrid graphics and new tools for performance monitoring is now available. One of the major updates in the RC 7 includes patches for the Leap Second bug that caused Linux systems to freeze because of permanent high CPU loads, which resulted in increased power consumption.

With a new version of X Server, the new kernel will deliver improved hybrid graphics support along with a variety of new and revised drivers, including support for 'FireWire Target Disk Mode'. The main difference for home PC users as well as professional systems administrators would be Prime infrastructure and Uprobes.

A new filter mechanism for Seccomp (Secure Computing Mode) has been added in this kernel, which would enable programs to set up filters. Also, an enhanced infrastructure feature improves the security of Linux Containers (LXC).

Lenovo to release Ideapad K1 tablet

While people are eyeing Google's latest Android Jelly Bean, here comes some news from ICS land. Lenovo is finally releasing an Android Ice Cream Sandwich update for the Ideapad K1 tablet. The 23.3-cm (10-inch) tablet was launched by Lenovo running the Android Honeycomb 3.0 operating system last year. And the device has been lagging behind in getting any sort of updates.

The Ice Cream Sandwich update was expected in the first quarter of the year but the company delayed it.

The ICS update is available for the IdeaPad K1 via Lenovo forums. Moreover, it is not mandatory for users to upgrade their device to Android 4.0. Those not interested can continue with the Honeycomb version of Android on their tablet.

This release is not a regular update. According to an online report, this release differs from the factory-installed Honeycomb 3.1 release and subsequent OTA (over the air) updates to Honeycomb 3.2, and it does not include Lenovo customisations such as the launcher, pre-installed apps, an app store, nor the underlying framework.



Dell brings out laptops with Red Hat Enterprise Linux

Dell has rolled out two new high-end mobile workstations with Red Hat Enterprise Linux 6 (RHEL 6) for desktops.

The company claims that the two new systems, called the Dell Precision M4700 and M6700, are the world's most powerful 38.1-cm (15-inch) and 43.2-cm (17-inch) mobile workstations. Both the models sport the latest Intel Core i5, i7 and Extreme Edition processors with Turbo Boost Technology. They also come packed with a range of graphics cards including NVIDIA's Quadro K-series GPUS and AMD FirePro graphics. M6700, which is the top of the line, offers AMD FirePro M6000 with PCIe x16 Gen 3 for fast data throughput. The laptops offer high-definition 1920x1080-pixel resolution.

The new laptops have three storage slots, which allow users to combine a 512 GB solidstate drive, a 256 GB SSD and a 750 GB hard drive. It is worth mentioning here that standard laptops offer 256 GB SSDs, but the new high-performance laptops like that of Apple's latest 39.1-cm (15.4-inch) MacBook Pro with Retina display are offered with 512 GB SSDs.

Jelly Bean for Motorola Xomm tablet

Here is a piece of good news for Motorola fans. The company is updating its Xoom Wi-Fi tablet to Android 4.1.1 a.k.a. Jelly Bean over the air. This update is only for the Wi-Fi version and Verizon users need not apply. Along with a new improved UI, Google's Project Butter has enhanced the entire Android experience in Jelly Bean. The search interface has got a new look and the voice search has been also enhanced to allow users to search their tablet in a better way.

The Notifications tray has got a completely new look and an improved keyboard makes text input faster, as it can smartly predict the next word.